

PREGNANCY: WHEN TO CALL YOUR DOCTOR

A Patient Guide — Geoffrey H. Klein, MD | OBGYN & Obesity Medicine

Congratulations on your pregnancy. Most symptoms in pregnancy are normal and related to hormonal and physical changes. However, some symptoms can be warning signs of a serious condition. Please contact our office or seek urgent care immediately if you experience any of the following:

CALL 911 OR GO TO THE ER IMMEDIATELY

- Chest pain
- Shortness of breath at rest or difficulty breathing
- Fainting or loss of consciousness
- Seizure
- Thoughts of harming yourself or others
- Heavy vaginal bleeding (soaking 1 pad/hour or large clots)

CALL OUR OFFICE IMMEDIATELY

Bleeding or Fluid Concerns

- Any vaginal bleeding
- Gush or steady leakage of fluid from the vagina
- Passing tissue
- Foul-smelling vaginal discharge

Pain

- Severe abdominal or pelvic pain
- Severe cramping not relieved by rest
- Persistent right upper abdominal pain (under ribs)
- Severe back pain with pelvic pressure
- Painful urination

Headache or Vision Changes

- Severe headache not improved with rest or Tylenol
- Blurred vision, flashing lights, or temporary vision loss
- Sudden swelling of face, hands, or around eyes

Blood Pressure / Preeclampsia Symptoms

- Severe or persistent headache
- Nausea/vomiting after mid-pregnancy
- Sudden swelling
- Decreased urine output
- Feeling generally unwell in second half of pregnancy

Fever or Infection

- Temperature $\geq 100.4^{\circ}\text{F}$
- Chills
- Severe body aches
- Persistent cough with shortness of breath
- Red, painful leg swelling (especially one-sided)

Decreased Baby Movement (After 24 Weeks)

- Noticeable decrease in baby's usual movement pattern
 - Fewer than 10 movements in 2 hours during active time
- Movement should not decrease toward the end of pregnancy.*

Preterm Labor Signs (Before 37 Weeks)

- Regular contractions (more than 4–6 per hour)
- Pelvic pressure
- Low dull backache
- Menstrual-like cramps
- Vaginal spotting or discharge changes

MENTAL HEALTH MATTERS

- Persistent sadness or hopelessness
- Severe anxiety or panic attacks
- Trouble sleeping unrelated to pregnancy discomfort
- Feeling overwhelmed or unable to cope

COMMON SYMPTOMS THAT ARE USUALLY NORMAL

(Still call if severe or concerning to you.)

- Mild nausea or vomiting
- Mild swelling of feet
- Occasional headaches
- Round ligament pain
- Mild shortness of breath with activity
- Braxton Hicks contractions (irregular, not painful, resolve with rest)

TRUST YOUR INSTINCTS

If something feels wrong, call. You know your body best. If you are unsure whether a symptom is serious, it is always appropriate to contact our office for guidance.

Office Phone: 281-557-0300 | After Hours: Follow the answering service instructions to reach the on-call physician.

Questions? Contact our office. This handout is for educational purposes only and does not replace personalized medical advice from your provider.

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